

HARDIK CHHABRA

INDIA TODAY RPG Happiness Quest

GURUSPEAK

"Beatitude comes when we are merciful"

By **HIS GRACE ANIL JOSEPH THOMAS COUTO**

Happiness is something that every human being yearns for, be it healthwise, wealthwise, in personal relationships or in social positions. No one wants to be unhappy. Whenever our dreams are fulfilled, our plans materialise, our needs are met, whether emotional or material, we experience happiness. But from a Christian perspective, happiness is deeper than this, which our Lord Jesus Christ has revealed to us. In fact, what our Lord Jesus Christ has spoken of is joy, rather than happiness. He has said, "My joy may be in you and that your joy may be full."

HAPPINESS MANTRA

"True happiness is not in self-centredness. Switch your focus to others. How can I bring joy to others...how can I help and uplift others"

What Jesus our Lord has given to us is the truth about being joyful. He says that you will be joyful when your hearts are open to God's grace. Therefore, repentance and conversion of hearts is the beginning of a life of joy, peace and love. When our Lord Jesus Christ began his ministry, he was in the desert, fasting and praying, and the evil one came to tempt him—to a life of pleasures, power, wealth and popularity. He shunned all this, telling the evil one: "You shall not tempt your Lord...for man shall not live on bread alone, but on every word that comes from the mouth of God." And, therefore, Christ our Lord has given to us the path of beatitudes. Beatitude means to be happy, to be joyful. And which is this path? He says, "Blessed are the poor in spirit." Therefore, joyfulness does not come in acquiring more and more wealth but being poor in spirit. Beatitude comes when we are merciful. Therefore, when we are compassionate, kind and gracious towards others, when we take care of the needs of others, then we will experience great joy and great happiness.

Also, when we reconcile with others rather than divide, we will experience great joy. And this is precisely the secret of joy which our Lord Jesus Christ has revealed: "Love one another as I have loved you." And how has he loved us? By sacrificing his life for us. Thus, true joy comes in sacrificing our life for others and not in trying to acquire everything for ourselves. When we remove from our hearts everything that is against God—all thoughts of hatred, evil and wickedness—and allow God's grace to fill our hearts, that is what's called to be "pure of heart". This is the secret to happiness. ■

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